Think Bayes Kernel

Math 452_552

2026-04-27

Goal

Install the ThinkBayes2 environment and register it as a Jupyter kernel.

Step 1: Open Anaconda Prompt

Search for **Anaconda Prompt** in the Windows Start Menu and open it.

Step 2: Download environment file

```
curl -O https://raw.githubusercontent.com/AllenDowney/ThinkBayes2/master/environment.yml
```

Step 3: Create the environment

```
conda env create -f environment.yml
```

Step 4:Install Jupyter kernel

```
conda run -n ThinkBayes2 python -m ipykernel install ^
  --user --name ThinkBayes2 ^
  --display-name "ThinkBayes2"
```

Step 5: Start Jupyter Notebook

jupyter notebook

Step 6: Select kernel

In Jupyter:

- Click Kernel
- Click Change Kernel
- Select ThinkBayes2

Step 7: Verify installation

Run this in a notebook cell:

```
import sys
print(sys.executable)
```

Expected output includes:

…anaconda3/envs/ThinkBayes2/python.exe

Step 8: Download the book data

- Make a directory for this class, mine is called Math452_552. You can call it whatever you want.
- Make a sub-directory called: data
- Go to the author's GitHub site:

https://github.com/AllenDowney/ThinkBayes2/tree/master/data

Click:

Code → Download ZIP

- Put the data files in your data directory

Step 9: Create a shortcut for this class.

If you have Anaconda installed, create a desktop shortcut to Jupyter Notebook.

- Go to your desktop and right click, select new shortcut.
- In the "Type the location of the item" box, enter

`C:\Users\YourUserName\AppData\Local\anaconda3\Scripts\jupyter-notebook.exe`

Replace YourUserName with your Windows login name.

- Name your shortcut Math452 (or Math 552). click finish
- Right click your new short cut.
- Click properties. In the Start in box put the path to your class directory and click ok.

This ensures every notebook you create starts in your Math 452/552 folder, making it easy to access the data directory.

Note, you can drag your shortcut to the task bar or put it in your start menu if you like.

Step 10: Testing

1. click on your short cut, make sure it opens Jupyter notebook in your class directory.
2. On the right, click new, ThinkBayes2.
3. Type the following commands into a python cell and run them.

```
import os
print(os.getcwd())
```

```
## C:\Users\kcaudle\Documents\SDSMT\Teaching\Fall 2026\Math 452_552
```

Make sure it gives your the class directory.

4. Load some data. In a python cell type and run these commands.

```
import pandas as pd
gss = pd.read_csv("data/gss_bayes.csv", index_col=0)
gss.head()
```